

Romeo and Juliet

Act III, Scene III (excerpt)

William Shakespeare

Friar Laurence's cell

sb. bolig

[...]

ROMEO

Father, what news? What is the Prince's doom?
What sorrow craves acquaintance at my hand
That I yet know not?

FRIAR LAURENCE

Too familiar

Is my dear son with such sour company:
I bring thee tidings of the Prince's doom.

ROMEO

What less than doomsday is the Prince's doom?

FRIAR LAURENCE

A gentler judgment vanished from his lips:
Not body's death, but body's banishment.

ROMEO

Ha, banishment? Be merciful, say 'death.'
For exile hath more terror in his look,
Much more, than death; do not say 'banishment'.

FRIAR LAURENCE

Here from Verona art thou banishèd.
Be patient, for the world is broad and wide.

ROMEO

There is no world without Verona walls,
But purgatory, torture, hell itself.
Hence 'banishèd' is 'banished from the world,'
And world's exile is death. Then 'banishèd'
Is death mis-termed. Calling death 'banishèd,'
Thou cut'st my head off with a golden axe,
And smilest upon the stroke that murders me.

FRIAR LAURENCE

O deadly sin! O rude unthankfulness!
Thy fault our law calls death, but the kind Prince,
Taking thy part, hath rushed aside the law,
And turned that black word 'death' to 'banishment.'
This is dear mercy, and thou seest it not.

ROMEO

'T is torture and not mercy. Heaven is here
Where Juliet lives, and every cat and dog

sb. parti

40	And little mouse, every unworthy thing, Live here in heaven and may look on her, But Romeo may not. More validity, More honorable state, more courtship lives In carrion flies than Romeo: They may seize	
45	On the white wonder of dear Juliet's hand And steal immortal blessing from her lips, Who even in pure and vestal modesty Still blush, as thinking their own kisses sin; But Romeo may not; he is banishèd.	<i>adj.</i> jomfruelig
50	Flies may do this, but I from this must fly; They are free men, but I am banishèd. And say'st thou yet that exile is not death? Hadst thou no poison mixed, no sharp-ground knife, No sudden mean of death , though ne'er so mean,	<i>adj.</i> skarpslebet <i>sb.</i> mordvåben
55	But 'banishèd' to kill me? 'Banishèd'! O Friar, the damnèd use that word in hell; Howling attends it. How hast thou the heart, Being a divine, a ghostly confessor, A sin-absolver, and my friend professed, To mangle me with that word 'banishèd'?	<i>vb.</i> mishandle
60	[...]	
	FRIAR LAURENCE I'll give thee armor to keep off that word, Adversity's sweet milk, philosophy, To comfort thee, though thou art banishèd.	
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	ROMEO Yet 'banishèd'? Hang up philosophy. Unless philosophy can make a Juliet, Displant a town, reverse a Prince's doom, It helps not, it prevails not. Talk no more.	
70	[...]	
	Thou canst not speak of that thou dost not feel. Wert thou as young as I, Juliet thy love, An hour but married, Tybalt murderèd, Doting like me, and like me banishèd, Then mightst thou speak, then mightst thou tear thy hair, And fall upon the ground, as I do now, Taking the measure of an unmade grave.	<i>vb.</i> were <i>adj.</i> dybt forelsket
75		
	<i>Knocking within</i>	
80	FRIAR LAURENCE Arise. One knocks. Good Romeo, hide thyself. [...]	
	Who knocks so hard? Whence come you? What's your will?	
	NURSE [from outside] Let me come in, and you shall know my errand.	
85		

I come from Lady Juliet.

FRIAR LAURENCE

Welcome, then.

Enter Nurse.

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NURSE

O holy Friar, O, tell me, holy Friar,
Where's my lady's lord? Where's Romeo?

FRIAR LAURENCE

There on the ground, with his own tears made drunk.

95

NURSE

O, he is even in my mistress' case,
Just in her case. O woeful sympathy!
Piteous predicament! Even so lies she,
Blubbering and weeping, weeping and blubbering.
[to Romeo] Stand up, stand up. Stand and you be a man!
For Juliet's sake; for her sake rise and stand.
Why should you fall into so deep an Ω ?

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[...]

ROMEO

105

Spak'st thou of Juliet? How is it with her?
Doth not she think me an old murderer,
Now I have stained the childhood of our joy
With blood removed but little from her own?
Where is she? And how doth she? And what says
My concealed lady to our canceled love?

vb. did you speak

110

NURSE

O, she says nothing, sir, but weeps and weeps,
And now falls on her bed, and then starts up,
And 'Tybalt' calls, and then on Romeo cries,
And then down falls again.

115

ROMEO

As if that name,
Shot from the deadly level of a gun,
Did murder her; as that name's cursèd hand
Murdered her kinsman. O, tell me, Friar, tell me,
In what vile part of this anatomy
Doth my name lodge? Tell me, that I may sack
The hateful mansion.

120

Drawing his dagger.